HALLOWEEN STORY · A1 · TEACHER

The Box at the Door

A Halloween story · A1 · present simple



WORDS

dark – tmavý, tma
sound – zvuk
candle – svíčka
behind – za
scary – strašidelný
face – obličej
move – hýbat se
neighbour – soused
quiet – tichý
pumpkin – dýně
laugh – smát se
garden – zahrada

It is 31 October. It is Halloween. It is 22:00 and it is dark.

Petra lives in a small house. She doesn't like Halloween. She doesn't watch scary films, and she doesn't like dark streets.

Tonight Petra is at home. She reads a book. The street is very quiet. The lights in the street aren't on. Nobody is outside.

Then Petra hears a sound at the door. She opens it. There is a big box. It isn't her box.

"Is this box for me?" she asks. Nobody answers.

The box has a face: two big eyes and a big smile. There is a light in the eyes. It is orange.

Petra calls her friend Jan.
"Jan, there is a box at my door. It has a face. Is it from you?"
"No, it isn't," Jan says. "I don't send boxes with faces. Does it have a name on it?"
"No, it doesn't."
"Petra… does the face move?"

Petra looks. The face doesn't move. But the light in the eyes moves.

Petra opens the box. Inside, there is a big orange pumpkin. It has a face, and there is a candle in it. Next to the pumpkin there is a card:

> ***"Happy Halloween, Petra! From Marek, your neighbour."***

Petra laughs. Marek isn't at home tonight. He is behind the tree in her garden!

"Do you like it?" Marek asks.
"No, I don't," Petra says. Then she smiles. "OK. Yes, I do. A little."



Did you know?

A pumpkin with a face and a candle is a **jack-o'-lantern**. The first jack-o'-lanterns are from Ireland, and they aren't pumpkins. They are **turnips** (tuřín)! Pumpkins come from America.

1 · Short answers

Answer with *Yes, she does. / No, it isn't...*

1 Does Petra like Halloween? *No, she doesn't.*

2 Is the street quiet? *Yes, it is.*

3 Is Petra at home tonight? *Yes, she is.*

4 Does the box have a name on it? *No, it doesn't.*

5 Is the box from Jan? *No, it isn't.*

6 Does Petra like the pumpkin? *Yes, she does. (A little!)*

2 · Understand the story

Answer the questions. Short answers are OK: *At 22:00.*

7 What time is it? *It's 22:00.*

8 What does Petra read? *She reads a book.*

9 Where is the box? *It's at the door.*

10 What colour is the light in the eyes? *It's orange.*

11 Who does Petra call? *She calls Jan.*

12 What is in the box? *A pumpkin with a face and a candle.*

13 Who is Marek? *He's Petra's neighbour.*

14 Where is Marek? *He's behind the tree in her garden.*

3 · Make it true

The sentence is wrong. Write the negative + the true sentence.
Example: Petra likes Halloween. → She doesn't like Halloween.

15 Petra watches scary films.

She doesn't watch scary films.

16 Petra is at work tonight.

She isn't at work. She's at home.

17 Petra watches TV tonight.

She doesn't watch TV. She reads a book.

18 The lights in the street are on.

The lights in the street aren't on.

19 The box is small.

It isn't small. It's big.

20 The box is from Jan.

It isn't from Jan. It's from Marek.

21 Jan sends boxes with faces.

Jan doesn't send boxes with faces.

22 The face moves.

The face doesn't move. The light moves.

23 Marek is at home.

Marek isn't at home. He's behind the tree.

💬 **Your turn** Do you like Halloween? · Do you have a pumpkin at home? · Do you watch scary films?

How to use it (15–20 min)

1. You read the story aloud once. The student only listens. Then he/she reads it aloud. · 2. Go through the words box first if needed.
3. Exercises 1 and 3: **say it first, then write it.** In 3 the student writes the negative *and* the true sentence. · 4. In Exercise 2 accept short answers (*At 22:00.* / *Jan.*).
5. Finish with 💬 *Your turn*: free talk, don't correct small mistakes. · Grammar: only present simple (am / is / are, do / does), nothing new.